

Iris

Automated image accessibility & compliance for Slack

Slack runs on images — charts, dashboards, screenshots. For a blind or low-vision teammate using a screen reader, every one is a dead end: “Image. No description.” Slack’s alt-text is optional and manual, so nobody adds it. The accessibility feature exists; the accessibility does not.

■ WHAT IRIS DOES

- Reads the actual data in a chart — figures, labels, axis values, error text — not just “a bar chart.”
- Answers the conversation — describes the image as an answer to the question being discussed in the thread.
- Remembers & diffs recurring dashboards — reports only what changed (“APAC dropped from \$4.2M to \$3.0M”).
- Learns how each person reads (plain-language DM) and delivers personalized descriptions to screen-reader users.
- Writes native, standards-compliant screen-reader alt-text, delivered as clean text a screen reader speaks aloud.
- Proves impact with a live coverage metric — images made accessible and manual alt-texting time saved.

■ HOW IT’S BUILT

Slack Bolt (Python) + Socket Mode · Slack Assistant / Agent APIs · a custom MCP server (memory, preferences, impact stats) · Real-Time Search API (assistant.search.context) · Block Kit · multimodal vision (Llama-4 via Groq, zero-retention) · deployed 24/7 on Render. Accessible by design: plain-text replies, reduced-motion, and the Atkinson Hyperlegible typeface throughout.

■ WHY IT MATTERS

1 in 6 people live with a disability. The European Accessibility Act became enforceable in June 2025, and the ADA and Section 508 already require accessible workplace tools. Iris shifts accessibility from the disabled employee’s daily burden to an automated, measurable, organization-wide capability — a reason for every workspace to adopt it, not just teams that happen to have a blind employee today.

Live app: iris-agent-8msr.onrender.com

Architecture: iris-agent-8msr.onrender.com/architecture Code: github.com/radhikaaudichya07/Iris_agent